

knowledge would have hopefully put his fears to rest and prevented his spending spree. If they had had an honest discussion about their upbringings, they could have gained a much deeper understanding of each other. Since attitudes and beliefs about money are very powerful and can determine behavior, Kim's knowledge of Bret's attitudes could have provided the clue to his sudden accumulation of expensive items and lavish spending.

To get insight into your own attitudes toward money, it is helpful to ask the following questions:

- How important is money to me?
- Is being wealthy one of my goals?
- What does money allow me to do?
- How do I handle it when I don't have enough money?

The answers to these questions can provide an initial glimpse into the role that money does and will play in your life.

Where Did the Money Go?

The old saying “Money doesn't grow on trees” could be replaced in modern times by the saying, “Money doesn't just come from the machine.” Both of these sayings are trying to convey the fact that money usually has to be worked for. Trying to get money the fast and easy way is usually not a good idea—it may involve something illegal or highly risky. The promise of quick riches is usually just that, a promise.

You never should rely on money as a sure thing, even if it comes from the normal channels like a paycheck, a formal loan, or a scholarship. You could lose your job, default on your loan, or have your scholarship taken away. In the case of other not so formal channels, like a loan shark or gambling, the reliability of receiving the money is even more dubious. Problems can result when you start relying on something

